

CUI//SP-SSEL

**General Services Administration
Federal Acquisition Service (FAS), General Supplies and Services (GSS),
Assisted Contracting Branch B (QSCBCA)
Limited Source Justification (LSJ)**

**I. IDENTIFICATION OF THE AGENCY AND CONTRACTING ACTIVITY, AND
SPECIFIC IDENTIFICATION OF THE DOCUMENT AS A LIMITED SOURCE
JUSTIFICATION:**

Contracting Activity:	General Services Administration (GSA) Federal Acquisition Service (FAS) General Supplies and Services (GSS) Assisted Contracting Branch B (QSCBCA) 819 Taylor St., Fort Worth, TX 76102
Requiring Activity and Address:	Department of the Air Force Air Force Life Cycle Management Center (AFLCMC) 2590 Loop Road Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, OH 45433
Description of Requirement:	Palletized Seating Part Number: 50472001 Part Number: 50471003
GSA's Acquisition PIID #	47QSWC24K0077
Vendor's Name and Address:	AAR Manufacturing Inc 201 Haynes Street Cadillac, MI 49601
Procurement Vehicle:	Multiple Award Schedule (MAS), FAR 8.4
Primary North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) code and Title:	332999: All Other Miscellaneous Fabricated Metal Product Manufacturing
Size Standard:	750 Employees
GSA Category/Special Item Number (SIN) and description:	332999P: Spill Containment Units, Containment Pallets, Non-Wooden Pallets
Product Service Code (PSC) code and Title:	3990: Miscellaneous Materials Handling Equipment
Period of Performance (POP):	Base Year with Four (4) One-Year Option Periods
Estimated BPA Value:	\$55,000,000.00

CUI//SP-SSEL

II. NATURE AND/OR DESCRIPTION OF THE ACTION BEING APPROVED:

This action is to request the approval of a limited source, single award, Blanket Purchase Agreement (BPA) for the supply of palletized seating systems (PSS) compatible with the existing KC-46 cargo plane restraint system and existing United States Air Force (USAF) material handling equipment (MHE). This requirement is in support of Air Mobility Command (AMC) Air Force Life Cycle Management Center (AFLCMC) at Wright-Patterson Air Force Base in Ohio.

The manufacturer and sole distributor of the required deliverables is AAR Manufacturing, Inc. The BPA will be awarded against AAR Manufacturing, Inc.'s General Services Administration (GSA) Multiple Award Schedule (MAS) contract, 47QSWA21D000M (ultimate contract end date November 15, 2040), in accordance with (IAW) Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 8.405-3 Blanket Purchase Agreements. Sources were limited IAW FAR 8.405-6(a)(1)(i)(B), only one source is capable of providing the supplies or services required at the level of quality required because the supplies or services are unique or highly specialized.

III. DESCRIPTION OF THE SUPPLIES OR SERVICES REQUIRED TO MEET THE AGENCY'S NEEDS (INCLUDING THE ESTIMATED VALUE):

Required Part Number(s):

CLIN	Manufacturer/Supplier	Part Number	Product Description
0001	AAR Manufacturing, Inc	50471003	10 Passenger Seat Pallet
0002	AAR Manufacturing, Inc	50472001	12 Passenger Seat Pallet

Salient Characteristics:

Pallet Configuration

IAW MIL-STD-1791B, the seat pallet shall be compatible with existing KC-46 cargo restraint system and existing USAF MHE.

Seat pallet base, where it interfaces with both the USAF MHE and KC-46 cargo restraint system, shall be dimensionally identical to an HCU-6/E, 463L cargo pallet, 88 inches by 108 inches.

Markings shall be on the seat tracks to make it easy to install seats in the correct location for each configuration.

Two pallet configurations shall be required:

108-inch bias pallets shall hold 10 forward facing seats.

88-inch bias pallets shall hold 12 forward facing seats.

12 seat pallets shall be re-configurable to remove one row of seats, as required, to provide a cross aisle egress when the seat pallet is installed near the over-wing exits, typically position 4.

The fully loaded pallet configuration, with the seats, shall contain the following:

Emergency Passenger Oxygen System (EPOS)

CUI//SP-SSEL

Floatation device

Bridge plate

The fully loaded pallets shall not exceed the following total weight:

108-inch bias cannot exceed a total weight of 3520 pounds.

88-inch bias cannot exceed a total weight of 4320 pounds.

Maximum weight per passenger not to exceed 250 pounds.

Personal bags not to exceed 10 pounds per passenger.

Center of Gravity

The fully loaded seat pallet cannot exceed a center of gravity (C.G.) height of 30.75 inches.

Loading Qualifications

PSS shall comply with Society of Automotive Engineers (SAE) AS8049 for all impact loading qualification standards.

The contractor shall also provide test data using SAE AS8049D loading conditions with 250-pound passengers on the seating system including the pallet structure, mounting, and supporting structure, and all attachment points demonstrating the system requirements are met at proposal submission.

Repair

The seat pallet shall be maintainable with common tools.

Forward Bridge Plate

Pallets shall have an integrated forward bridge plate to bridge the gap between the pallet and the pallet in front of it. The bridge plate will aid in egress operations and shall not present a tripping hazard or interfere with KC-46 cargo handling equipment.

Anti-Rattle Device

Pallets shall be equipped with an "anti-rattle" clamping device that minimizes pallet movement with a minimum slip force of 200 pounds.

KC-46 Loading

Pallets shall meet maximum pallet position loading on KC-46 per TO 1C-46(K)A-9.

Emergency Egress

The design of the PSS shall not adversely impact the emergency egress analysis performed by the aircraft OEM. The contractor shall verify, by analysis, passenger egress per MIL-HDBK-516C, section 9.1.2.

Pallet All-Weather Covering

Each PSS shall come complete with a cover that is:

Dark blue

Pliable enough to fold up and have its own bag for storage.

The storage bag and seat pallet cover shall be marked with a corresponding serial number to match with its applicable PSS.

CUI//SP-SSEL

Supplemental Restraints

Supplemental restraints (e.g. braces, struts, guy wires, etc.) are not permitted if the safety or operability of the aircraft will be hindered by them.

Certification

PSS shall meet USAF air-worthiness certification requirements for KC-46 passenger movement operations to include crash load survivability per MIL-HDBK-516C:

Section 9.7.1, "Seating System Load Capability"

Section 9.7.3, "Restraint Systems Loads"

Section 9.7.4, "Occupant Strike Envelope"

Section 18.1.1, "Passenger Seating and Restraint Systems"

If contractor seats are certified to Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) Technical Standard Order (TSO)-C127, they may use that certification as verification of meeting the SAE AS8049D requirements for their seats. However, the FAA TSO-C127 certification only applies to the seats. The entire PSS, to include the seats, must still be qualified to MIL-HDBK-516C airworthiness standards.

Seat Configuration

Seat cover material shall be medium blue in color.

Seat cover material shall meet industry standards for durability in austere environments to withstand the harsh conditions with the ability of being easily maintained, ensuring longevity in challenging environments.

Each seat shall include a back-of-seat accessory pocket.

Each seat shall have padded armrests; arm rests shall be locked in the arm rest position. Arm rests, when unlocked, shall allow rotation of the arm rest upward for out-of-the-way storage.

Each seat shall have reclining seatbacks and tray tables.

Each seat shall have a single point release restraint system that meets MIL-HDBK-516C requirements per section 18.1.2, "Restraint System Release Point."

Each seat shall accommodate stowage of hand carried baggage beneath it. Storage space will not exceed 18 inches wide by 15 inches long by 8 inches tall and ten pounds in weight.

Seat-To-Track Connections Verification

A static test is required to verify the capability of the seat to track connections. For assembly and/or its components not statically tested, structural analysis is required. Margins of safety must equal or exceed 0.05 with the exception for operational download ultimate condition, a margin of safety of 0.25 is required. For any fittings including seat to track local attachments, a fitting factor of 1.15 or higher shall be used. The contractor shall provide proof of TSO C127 certification and/or static and dynamic test data at proposal submission.

Clean Air Act

Ensure that new designs or modifications meet the requirement of Title VI of the Clean Air Act Amendments, Public Law 102-804, and AFI 32-7080.

This BPA is a Firm-Fixed Price agreement with one (1) base year with four (4) one-year options. The estimated value of \$55 Million is based upon historical data and estimated orders in the pipeline. During annual review of the BPA IAW FAR 8.405-3(e), the Contracting Officer shall

CUI//SP-SSEL

determine in writing whether the MAS contract, upon which the BPA was established, is still in effect, the BPA still represents the best value IAW FAR 8.404(d), and estimated quantities/amounts have been exceeded and additional price reductions can be obtained.

IV. THE AUTHORITY AND SUPPORTING RATIONALE (SEE 8.405-6(a)(1)(i) AND (b)(1) AND IF APPLICABLE, A DEMONSTRATION OF THE PROPOSED CONTRACTOR'S UNIQUE QUALIFICATIONS TO PROVIDE THE REQUIRED SUPPLY OR SERVICE:

This acquisition will be conducted under the authority of the GSA MAS Program. The primary statutory authorities for MAS are Title III of the Federal Property and Administrative Services Act of 1949 (41 USC 251 ET SEQ), and Title 40 U.S.C. 501, Services for Executive Agencies.

This acquisition will be procured against the MAS program under GSA Special Item Number/ GSA Category 332999P, titled: Spill Containment Units, Containment Pallets, Non-Wooden Pallets. FAR 8.405-6(a)(1)(i)(B) applies when only one source is capable of providing the supplies or services required at the level of quality required because the supplies or services are unique or highly specialized.

AMC holds the responsibility of executing the deployment and transportation of all unit personnel during wartime and contingency operations. The KC-46 aircraft is used to facilitate the deployment and transportation of these unit personnel. The KC-46 aircraft Capability Development Document (CDD) Airlift Capability Key Performance Parameter #4 requires the aircraft's entire main cargo deck be convertible to an all-passenger configuration. The CDD also requires the cargo compartment to permit 463L pallets access on the wide dimension or coupled on the short side to be loadable with adequate room to turn (to line up inside).

AFLCMC's current KC-46 inventory consists of 75 PSSs manufactured by AAR Manufacturing, Inc. AAR Manufacturing, Inc. received all the required airworthiness certifications meeting FAA TSO-C127 and SAE AS8049 requirements referenced in MIL-HDBK-516C.

Maintaining AAR Manufacturing, Inc. as the sole supplier of PSSs allows for a standardized logistics strategy and reduced footprint at KC-46 depots and deployed locations. There is a need for interoperability between the existing inventory of PSSs and the PSSs to be procured. A single PSS provider prevents potential equipment failure due to incorrect part installation or replacement, operational delays due to mismatches with support assets, maintenance problems, down-time, and increased maintenance cost due to inconsistencies between equipment and its maintenance instructions; as well as numerous other circumstances which decrease operational effectiveness and add cost (MIL-HDBK-61B, par 1.1.3.f and g).

In summary, AAR Manufacturing, Inc. has been thoroughly vetted by AFLCMC and is the manufacturer and supplier of the current PSS inventory. Maintaining the interoperability with the current PSSs is essential for operational efficiency. Additionally, market research indicates AAR Manufacturing, Inc. is the only vendor on the Federal Supply Schedule (FSS) with the necessary certifications within MIL-HDBK-516C to ensure safety and airworthiness of the PSSs.

The circumstances and rationale for limiting consideration to AAR Manufacturing, Inc. for award have been met IAW with FAR 8.405-6(a)(1)(i)(B) – Only one source is capable of

CUI//SP-SSEL

providing the supplies or services required at the level of quality required because the supplies or services are unique or highly specialized. Approvals at the specified levels IAW FAR 8.405-6(d)(4) are being obtained.

V. A DETERMINATION BY THE ORDERING ACTIVITY CONTRACTING OFFICER THAT THE ORDER REPRESENTS THE BEST VALUE CONSISTENT WITH 8.404(d):

The best value determination will be conducted and documented prior to award. By placing an order against a MAS contract using the procedures in FAR 8.405, the ordering activity has concluded the order represents the best value (as defined in FAR 2.101) and results in the lowest overall cost alternative (considering price, special features, administrative costs, etc.) to meet the Government's needs. Any quote submitted by AAR Manufacturing, Inc. will be reviewed to ensure pricing terms are IAW their MAS contract. The Contracting Officer will seek price reductions IAW FAR 8.405-4.

IAW FAR 8.404(d) Pricing, GSA has already determined the prices of the supplies and fixed-price service under MAS contracts to be fair and reasonable. However, the Department of Defense (DoD) has issued Class Deviation 20014-00011, dated March 13, 2014, whereby the Contracting Officer is responsible for making a determination of fair and reasonable pricing for BPAs using the proposal analysis techniques outlined in FAR 15.404-1. Because this requirement is one-source, the Government will be utilizing at least two methods by which to determine pricing submitted by AAR Manufacturing Inc to be fair and reasonable. These techniques include, but not limited to, the following:

- Requesting recent commercial and Government sales history
- Direct competitive pricing comparisons
- Making indirect pricing comparisons to:
 - the same or similar items in the marketplace,
 - competitive published price lists, and/or
 - Independent Government Estimates.

VI. DESCRIPTION OF MARKET RESEARCH CONDUCTED AMONG SCHEDULE HOLDERS AND THE RESULTS OR A STATEMENT OF THE REASON MARKET RESEARCH WAS NOT CONDUCTED:

Market research was conducted IAW FAR Part 10 to determine the availability of products capable of meeting the Government's requirement. Market research revealed the required items were not available through AbilityOne, Unicor, Green Procurement Compilation or Interagency Contract Directory Portal. A search on GSA eLibrary revealed a total of nineteen (19) vendors have GSA Special Item Number (SIN)/Category 332999P added to their MAS contract. The results of the market research determined that while other companies in the open market could provide PSSs, only AAR Manufacturing, Inc. through their MAS contract would be able to meet the Government's requirement of providing compatible deliverables and retain the required certifications. A Request For Information (RFI) was posted to GSA eBuy from October 16, 2024 through October 30, 2024. The RFI identified the technical specifications required for the palletized seating. One response was received, and that was from AAR Manufacturing, Inc. AAR Manufacturing, Inc. stated they have previously provided the required palletized seats to

CUI//SP-SSEL

the Air Force, their seats have passed first article testing, and the seats are certified under TSO-C127.

The Contracting Officer also contacted AAR Manufacturing, Inc. to determine if other authorized distributors were available. A representative of AAR Manufacturing, Inc. confirmed via letter dated 07/19/2024 that AAR Manufacturing, Inc. is the only authorized distributor in the open market and on MAS for the required products.

VII. ANY OTHER FACTS SUPPORTING THE JUSTIFICATION:

Military Flight Release KC-46A-R0010 approved the above-mentioned AAR Manufacturing, Inc. PSSs for use on board the KC-46A aircraft. This flight release was issued pursuant to USAF Policy Directive 62-6 and Air Force Instruction 62-601. The flight release authorizes flight in accordance with approved operating manuals unless rescinded by the Technical Airworthiness Authority (TAA) or Director of Engineering-Level Delegated Technical Authority (DOE-Level DTA).

This requirement will not be synopsisized IAW FAR 5.202(a)(11), the proposed contract action is made under the terms of an existing contract that was previously synopsisized in sufficient detail to comply with the requirements of 5.207 with respect to the current proposed contract action.

VIII. A STATEMENT OF THE ACTIONS, IF ANY, THE AGENCY MAY TAKE TO REMOVE OR OVERCOME ANY BARRIERS THAT LED TO THE RESTRICTED CONSIDERATION BEFORE ANY SUBSEQUENT ACQUISITION FOR THE SUPPLIES OR SERVICES IS MADE:

AAR Manufacturing, Inc. is the current manufacturer and supplier of the existing PSS inventory. Maintaining interoperability with the current PSSs is essential for operational efficiency. Additionally, market research indicates that AAR Manufacturing, Inc. is the only vendor on the Federal Supply Schedule (FSS) with the necessary certifications within MIL-HDBK-516C to ensure the safety and airworthiness of the PSSs. To continue the process of overcoming barriers to competition, AMC will continue to evaluate the capabilities of other vendors through continuing market research and any changing needs of AFLCMC. Furthermore, any other dealer of a similar PSS is not sufficient, as the compatibility with existing PSSs and certification testing is crucial to providing airworthy products and aircraft sustainment.

IX. TECHNICAL/REQUIREMENTS CERTIFICATION:

I certify that the supporting data under my cognizance, which is included in this justification, is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

[Redacted Signature]

2/3/25

[Redacted Title]

Date

Wright-Patterson AFB, OH 45433

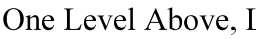
CUI//SP-SSEL

CONTRACTING OFFICER CERTIFICATION AND APPROVAL:

The Contracting Officer has determined that the appropriate actions were taken under this acquisition to meet the conditions described in FAR 8.405-6(a)(1)(i)(B). The information contained in this justification is accurate and complete to the best of the Contracting Officer’s knowledge and belief.

	2/3/2025
	Date
Contracting Officer, Large SOP (QSCBDA)	

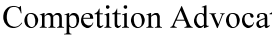
APPROVALS:

	2/3/2025
	Date
One Level Above, Large SOP (QSCBDA)	

	2/3/2025
	Date
Director, Special and Assisted Contracting Certification (QSC)	

	2/3/2025
	Date
Operational Guidance Branch SME (QSA)	

	2/3/2025
	Date
Assistant Regional Counsel (LD7)	

	2/3/2025
	Date
Competition Advocate (QSA)	

APPROVAL AUTHORITY CERTIFICATION

I, the approving authority, determine that the circumstances identified in this document are accurate; therefore, limiting competition to one source under FAR 8.405-6(a)(1)(i)(B) is justified. The signature below also represents approval of this Justification and Approval.

	2/5/2025
	Date
Contracting Executive (QSC), Delegated HCA Authority	